



A letter to our readers

From today, *Gulf News* is doing something we have wanted to do for a long time: bringing Abu Dhabi even closer to the heart of how we cover the UAE.

We have covered the emirate since *Gulf News* was launched in 1978, recording its incredible transformation into an international cultural capital. But we know we need to do more.

Every Monday to Friday, a dedicated Abu Dhabi section will now appear inside these pages, alongside expanded coverage online in a dedicated Abu Dhabi section and across our social media platforms. We are also launching a new Abu Dhabi Edit newsletter, which you can sign up for today.

This is all being made possible by the opening of a new and modern *Gulf News* office in the heart of Abu Dhabi, with more than ten journalists and members of staff working from the capital every day.

This is not a small step. Abu Dhabi is the seat of the UAE's government, the engine of much of its economic diversification, and increasingly a global centre for culture, sport, sustainability and innovation.

The stories that shape the emirate deserve reporters who are there, in the room, asking questions in real time, not filing from a distance.

For our readers in Abu Dhabi, this means faster, deeper and more relevant coverage told by journalists who know the emirate because they are part of it.

For Abu Dhabi itself, it means a stronger, more consistent record of its own progress, and one read not only across the capital, but by the millions who follow *Gulf News* across the UAE and the rest of the world every day.

For those who live across the other emirates, it's an opportunity to see how our nation's capital is developing while highlighting the incredible attractions and events that bring people in from across the globe.

We firmly believe great journalism is built on trust, but it is also built on proximity: to the people, the places and the institutions. When so many people report on the UAE from the outside, we can tell the real story as we are right here on the ground.

This expansion is our commitment to that principle, and to Abu Dhabi. We look forward to telling its story, every day, from the inside.

— The Gulf News Team



Scan the QR code for Abu Dhabi newsletter

GULF NEWS EXPANDS PRESENCE

Now, get faster, deeper and more relevant coverage of Abu Dhabi



GARGASH: STATES HAVE THE RIGHT TO MAKE SOVEREIGN DECISIONS

Respect for independent choices key to regional stability

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, said sovereign decision-making is an inherent right of states and should be guided by their national interests, circumstances and assessments.

In a post on X, Gargash said such decisions should also be consistent with the rules of international law. "Sovereign decisions are an inherent right of states and are taken in light of their national interests, circumstances and assessments, in a manner consistent with the rules of international law," he said.

Gargash noted that respect for the sovereignty of states and their independent choices is a fundamental principle for strengthening regional and international coexistence. "The UAE embodies an established model of independent decision-making and steadfast positions," he added.

Sheikh Abdullah praised

In a separate post, Gargash praised Sheikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs, for leading

IRAN RECEIVES US RESPONSE TO PROPOSAL

Iranian authorities said yesterday they received the official US response to their proposal to end the Middle East war, state media reported, days after US President Donald Trump rejected the plan. "At today's cabinet meeting, the American side's proposal was presented to President Masoud Pezeshkian by Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi," government spokeswoman Fatemeh Mohajerani told the official IRNA news agency, without specifying the content of the reply.

After seven months of conflict, indirect talks between the United States and Iran resumed last week on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly. Iran said it has put forward seven conditions for ending hostilities and reopening the strategic Strait of Hormuz, a vital route for oil and gas exports.

—AFP

an intensive diplomatic and economic drive during the UN General Assembly in New York, saying hundreds of meetings strengthened the UAE's international presence and expanded its global partnerships.

Sheikh Abdullah led the UAE delegation to the 81st session of the UN General Assembly, whose High-Level Week ran from September 22 to 28. The delegation included ministers and senior officials spanning foreign affairs, trade, industry, climate, health and international cooperation.

"All thanks and appreciation to my brother Sheikh Abdullah Bin Zayed for his outstand-

ing leadership of the large UAE diplomatic and economic delegation during the UN General Assembly week in New York," Gargash said.

He also praised UAE officials and diplomats for their efforts and active engagement throughout the week.

"Hundreds of meetings and engagements, under his leadership, embodied an active and comprehensive diplomacy that strengthens the UAE's presence and standing and expands its partnerships with the world," Gargash said.

Throughout the week, Sheikh Abdullah held a series of meetings with foreign min-

isters and senior officials from around the world, with discussions spanning trade, investment, advanced technology, artificial intelligence, energy, food security, education, health and climate action.

National effort

The meetings also addressed regional and international developments, multilateral cooperation and efforts to promote peace and security. Sheikh Abdullah reiterated the UAE's commitment to expanding international partnerships and constructive dialogue to support sustainable development and stability.

Gargash described the week's diplomatic activity as a national effort in which the UAE could take pride, saying it was underpinned by an established record of credibility, contribution, trust and international partnerships.

The UAE entered this year's General Assembly with three stated priorities: Advancing conflict resolution and global stability; supporting reforms to make the United Nations more effective, including through the responsible use of AI; and promoting climate action and sustainable water solutions.

SEE ALSO P6

Altercation in cockpit forces flydubai flight to divert to Saudi Arabia

On-duty crew secured aircraft and landed safely in Tabuk after incident

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

A flydubai flight from Dubai to Tel Aviv landed safely in Tabuk, Saudi Arabia, after experiencing an incident while en route yesterday, the airline said.

"An altercation occurred in the flight deck of flight FZ 1073, operating from Dubai International (DXB) to Ben Gurion International Airport (TLV), on September 30," confirmed a flydubai spokesperson.

"The aircraft was successfully secured by on-duty flydubai crew travelling on the flight, who diverted and landed the aircraft safely at Tabuk Airport (TUU). All passengers and crew are safe and accounted for."

Flights on schedule

flydubai added that it has deployed two replacement aircraft to Tabuk to relieve the passengers and crew. The airline said the incident has no impact on other scheduled operations across its network.

"At this early stage, the underlying reasons and motives behind this event are unknown and remain subject

flydubai said that it has deployed two replacement aircraft to Tabuk to relieve the passengers and crew.

to a formal investigation. We urge all parties to refrain from premature speculation while authorities gather the facts," the statement noted.

"Our immediate priority is to ensure the ongoing safety, health, and wellbeing of all passengers and crew members involved in this incident and support the official investigation."

Separately, Cluster2 Airports, operator of Prince Sultan Bin Abdulaziz International Airport in Tabuk, said air traffic control received a distress call from FZ1073 requesting an emergency landing at 8.44am local time. The airport declared an emergency before the aircraft landed safely at 9.45am.

The Saudi airport operator said the captain and co-pilot sustained injuries and were transferred to hospital for medical care. Passengers were assisted at the terminal while arrangements were made for replacement aircraft. Authorities are investigating the circumstances surrounding the incident.